town of Lyallpur, radiating out from the central clock tower, were laid out. And yet, there was a downside that arose from an insuperable contradiction. It was not a minor matter of detail. Where there was order there was also transformation. The two made uncomfortable bed-fellows. Local settlement officers wanted to espouse a modern cultivator in the ordered world of the colony villages. But the Lieutenant-Governor Sir Charles Aitcheson simply wanted ‘a manly peasantry capable of self-support and of loyal . . . disposition’. [4]

The Punjab Colonisation of Land Bill was introduced by the government in these circumstances in October 1906 in the local legislative council. Its conditions on issues such as sanitation, tree planting and construction, when imposed on the Chenab Colony, were retroactive however. The penalty for breach of conditions was fines imposed in the same way as the collection of revenue. The farmer could not turn to the courts for relief because under Section 31 the courts were deprived of jurisdiction in the Colony. As if this was not bad enough, the following month in November, the occupier rate, involving a charge on canal water, was raised hugely by the government. The Bari Doab Canal area ran through the districts of Amritsar, Gurdaspur and Lahore, and here the rates had been traditionally lower, because the government had adopted a policy of leniency in revenue to ensure the loyalty of the Sikh Jats who supplied recruits for the Indian Army. [5] When the bill sought to extract the extra legal fees in the Chenab Colony, this was vehemently contested by the yeomen farmers. Corruption and maladministration now stood to be challenged as the entire system of interference and paternalism began to be opposed. James Ker recognizes that the raising of the water rates on the Bari Doab Canal in the Lahore District ‘was resented by the cultivators’ and these grievances led to ‘an easy transition’ of ‘anti-British feelings’, which even resulted in ‘assaults on Europeans in Lahore and Rawalpindi’. However, ‘[t]he trouble in the Lyallpur district was the most dangerous for two reasons: first because special attention was directed to military pensioners of whom the colony was full, and secondly because it spread naturally from there to districts from which the canal colonists originally came.’ It did not stop there,